

## Nausea & Vomiting, Including Motion Sickness

Nausea and vomiting can occur for various reasons, including food poisoning, infections, fever, migraine, stress, or emotional problems, as well as travel sickness. For short-term conditions, there are many herbs that reduce or relieve the unpleasant, empty, gnawing symptoms of nausea and vomiting. Most of the herbs listed are also very useful for travel sickness.

**Ginger**, in particular, and other close relatives such as galangal and turmeric, are widely used for nausea and vomiting. They help to “warm” and settle the digestion.

**Chiretta** strengthens weak digestion and relieves nausea.

**Lemon** is an excellent cleansing remedy for weak and sluggish digestion.

If you are pregnant, or suspect you may be pregnant, see *Morning Sickness*, p. 317, before taking any of these remedies.

❗ **General caution** Seek professional advice if nausea is severe or is recurrent. All types or species of mint (*Mentha* spp.) are unsuitable for children under 5.

### Nausea & Motion Sickness

**Herbs** Ginger (*Zingiber officinale*, p. 155), galangal (*Alpinia officinarum*, p. 61), turmeric (*Curcuma longa*, p. 90)

**Remedy** Make an infusion with one of the herbs listed using about 1–2 slices (0.5 g) of fresh root or ¼–½ tsp of dried, powdered, or grated root to ¾ cup (150 ml) of water. Use the fresh root if possible. Infuse for at least 5 minutes and sip while hot. Drink up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day. Add 1–2 cloves (*Eugenia caryophyllata*, p. 97) if desired.

**Option** Use the remedy under *Nausea with Headache*.

**Tip** For travel sickness, take the infusion in a flask or chew crystallized ginger.

### Weak Digestion

**Herbs** Chiretta (*Swertia chirata*, p. 273), centaury (*Erythraea centaurium*, p. 206)

**Remedy** Take 2–4 drops of one of the tinctures on the tongue each hour.

**Herb** Lemon (*Citrus limon*, p. 82)

**Remedy** Drink the freshly squeezed juice of a lemon, neat or diluted, each morning.

### Nausea due to Emotional Problems

**Herb** Lemon balm (*Melissa officinalis*, p. 113)

**Remedy** Make an infusion with the dried herb or use 2 tsp of fresh herb per ¾ cup (150 ml) of water. Drink up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day.

### Vomiting with Dizziness & Vertigo

**Herb** Black horehound (*Ballota nigra*, p. 176)

**Remedy** Make an infusion and drink up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day.

❗ **Caution** Seek professional advice if symptoms do not immediately improve.

### Nausea with Headache

**Herbs** Peppermint (*Mentha x piperita*, p. 114), pennyroyal (*Mentha pulegium*, p. 235), bo he (*Mentha haplocalyx*, p. 234)

**Remedy** Make an infusion with 1 level tsp of one herb per ¾ cup (150 ml) of water. Drink up to 2½–3 cups (600–750 ml) a day.

**Other uses** This remedy combats abdominal fullness and helps improve the appetite and digestion.

**Caution** Do not give these herbs to children under 5. Do not take pennyroyal during pregnancy.

### Loss of Appetite & Vomiting

**Herb** Codonopsis (*Codonopsis pilosula*, p. 83)

**Remedy** Make a decoction and sip 2½ tbsps (50 ml) every 2–3 hours until the vomiting stops or the dose has been taken over 2 days.

**Other uses** For anorexia, add 5 g of licorice (*Glycyrrhiza glabra*, p. 101).

**Caution** Do not take licorice during pregnancy.

## Gas & Bloating

Gas and bloating are common digestive problems. As a preventative, take bitter herbs, such as centaury and gentian, which improve digestion. Infusions of aromatic plants such as fennel, cardamom, anise, lemon verbena, or peppermint are effective remedies. All the herbs listed under *General Remedies* can be combined by adjusting the measurements of each herb using the same proportion to water.

**General cautions** Bitters are generally unsuitable and unpalatable for children under 5. All types or species of mint (*Mentha* spp.) are unsuitable for children under 5.

### Protection & Prevention

**Herbs** Centaury (*Erythraea centaurium*, p. 206), gentian (*Gentiana lutea*, p. 99)

**Remedy** Take 5–10 drops of tincture 3 times a day with water.

### General Remedies

**Herbs** Fennel (*Foeniculum vulgare*, p. 212), anise (*Pimpinella anisum*, p. 248)

**Remedy** Make an infusion with ¼–½ tsp of fennel or anise seeds per ¾ cup (150 ml) of water and drink up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day.

**Herb** Cardamom (*Elettaria cardamomum*, p. 93)

**Remedy** Make an infusion with the crushed seeds of 2 cardamoms per ¾ cup (150 ml) of water. Drink up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day.

**Herb** Lemon verbena (*Lippia citriodora*, p. 228)

**Remedy** Make an infusion using 1 tsp of dried or 2 tsp of fresh leaves per 1 cup (150 ml) of water and take up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day.

**Herb** Peppermint (*Mentha x piperita*, p. 114)

**Remedy** Make an infusion and drink up to 3 cups (750 ml) a day. (See *General cautions*.)

## Mouth Ulcers & Gum Problems

Many astringent herbs can be used to treat mouth ulcers and tighten up weak gums and loose teeth. Sage is particularly effective as it also disinfects the mouth. Myrrh tincture will sting but it will also increase the rate of healing.

### General Remedies

**Herb** Myrrh (*Commiphora molmol*, p. 85)

**Remedy** Dab neat tincture onto mouth ulcers and infected gums once every hour.

**Herb** Sage (*Salvia officinalis*, p. 131)

**Remedy** Use an infusion as a mouthwash, or rub gums with leaves or powder.

### Mouth & Tongue Ulcers

**Herbs** Myrrh (*Commiphora molmol*, p. 85), echinacea (*Echinacea* spp., p. 92), licorice (*Glycyrrhiza glabra*, p. 101)

**Remedy** Mix equal parts of the tinctures and apply neat or diluted (1 part tincture to 5 parts water) every hour.